

CLASS 10 NOTES

HISTORY

print culture and the modern world

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PRINT CULTURE AND THE MODERN WORLD

1 The First Printed Books

← EXAM MEI AYEKA

E.M.A

- China, Japan and Korea developed the earliest kind of print technology, which was a system of hand printing.
- Books in China were printed by rubbing paper from AD 594 and both the sides of the book were folded and stitched.
- China for a long time was the major producer of printed material.
- China started conducting civil service examinations for its bureaucrats and its textbooks were printed in vast numbers.
- Print was no longer confined to scholar-officials. Merchants used print while collecting their trade information.
- Reading became a part of leisure activity and rich women started publishing their own poetry and plays.
- This new reading culture attracted new technology.
- In the late 19th century, Western printing techniques and mechanical presses were imported.

CALLIGRAPHY – THE ART OF BEAUTIFUL AND STYLISED WRITING

1.1 Print in Japan

Buddhist missionaries from China brought hand-printing technology to Japan between AD 768-770. The oldest Japanese book, the Buddhist Diamond Sutra, was printed in AD 868, featuring six sheets of text and woodcut illustrations. This introduction of printing led to unique publishing practices. By the late 19th century, collections of illustrated paintings portrayed sophisticated urban life, and libraries and bookstores were filled with hand-printed materials, covering diverse topics like books on women and musical instruments.



Kitagawa Utamaro, born in Edo in 1753, was widely known for his contributions to an art form called ukiyo ('pictures of the floating world') or depiction of ordinary human experiences, especially urban ones. These prints travelled to contemporary US and Europe and influenced artists like Manet, Monet and Van Gogh. Publishers like Tsutaya Juzaburo identified subjects and commissioned artists who drew the theme in outline. Then a skilled woodblock carver pasted the drawing on a woodblock and carved a printing block to reproduce the painter's lines. In the process, the original drawing would be destroyed and only prints would survive.

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– A morning scene, ukiyo print by Shunman Kubo, late eighteenth century. A man looks out of the window at the snowfall while women prepare tea and perform other domestic duties

2 Print Comes to Europe

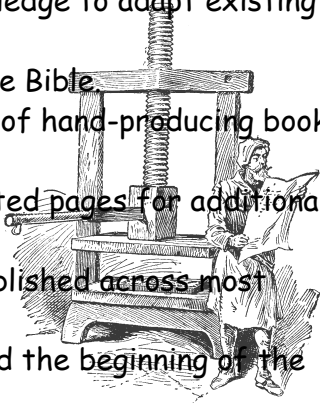
Chinese paper arrived in Europe during the eleventh century through the Silk Road. Marco Polo, who had studied in China, returned to Europe and brought back knowledge of woodblock printing. As the demand for books increased, bookstores across Europe began selling books to different countries. Handwritten manuscripts couldn't meet the growing need for books. By the early fifteenth century, woodblocks were commonly used in Europe. Johann Gutenberg invented the first printing press in the 1430s in Strasbourg.

VELLUM – A PARCHMENT MADE FROM THE SKIN OF ANIMALS

2.1 Gutenberg and the Printing Press

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- Gutenberg, skilled in polishing stones, used his knowledge to adapt existing technology for his innovation.
- The first book printed using this new system was the Bible.
- Despite the new technology, the traditional method of hand-producing books persisted.
- Books for the wealthy included blank spaces on printed pages for additional decoration.
- Between 1450 and 1550, printing presses were established across most European countries.
- The shift from manual to mechanical printing marked the beginning of the print revolution.



Gutenberg Printing Press. Notice the long handle attached to the screw. This handle was used to turn the screw and press down the platen over the printing block that was placed on top of a sheet of damp paper. Gutenberg developed metal types for each of the 26 characters of the Roman alphabet and devised a way of moving them around so as to compose different words of the text. This came to be known as the moveable type printing machine, and it remained the basic print technology over the next 300 years. Books could now be produced much faster than was possible when each print block was prepared by carving a piece of wood by hand. The Gutenberg press could print 250 sheets on one side per hour

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PLATEN – IN LETTERPRESS PRINTING, PLATEN IS A BOARD WHICH IS PRESSED ONTO THE BACK OF THE PAPER TO GET THE IMPRESSION FROM THE TYPE. AT ONE TIME IT USED TO BE A WOODEN BOARD; LATER IT WAS MADE OF STEEL



Gutenberg's Bible, the first printed book in Europe, had approximately 180 copies, with fewer than 50 still in existence.

Each page of the Gutenberg Bible was a unique creation, going beyond the capabilities of new technology. While the text was printed using the Gutenberg press with metal type, the borders were carefully crafted, painted, and illuminated by hand by skilled artists. No two copies were the same, and even seemingly similar ones had noticeable differences upon close examination.

This lack of uniformity was favored by elites, as it made each copy distinct and exclusive. The use of color within the letters had a dual purpose: adding vibrancy to the page and emphasizing the significance of holy words. However, the color was applied by hand on every page since Gutenberg printed the text in black, leaving spaces for later manual coloring.



This image shows a printer's workshop in the sixteenth century, where all the tasks are happening in one place. In the front on the right, compositors are working, and on the left, galleys are being readied while ink is applied to metal types. In the background, printers are operating the press, and nearby proofreaders are checking the work. At the forefront are the finished products – double-page printed sheets neatly stacked, ready to be bound.

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3 The Print Revolution and Its Impact

The Print Revolution goes beyond just altering how books are made; it revolutionized people's lives, reshaping their connections to information, knowledge, institutions, and authorities.

3.1 A New Reading Public

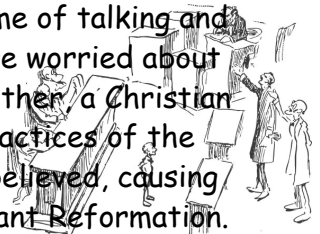
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The print revolution lowered the cost of books, making them more affordable. A flood of books entered the markets, reaching an expanding audience. This gave rise to a new reading culture. In the past, only elites were allowed to read, and common people listened to sacred texts being read aloud.

Before the print revolution, books were costly, and the shift wasn't just about literacy. Printers began publishing popular ballads and folk tales with illustrations for those who couldn't read. Oral culture transitioned into print, and printed materials were shared verbally.

3.2 Religious Debates and the Fear of Print

Printing allowed ideas to spread widely, bringing about a new time of talking and debating. However, not everyone liked printed books. Some were worried about rebellious and irreligious ideas being shared. In 1517, Martin Luther, a Christian reformer, wrote the Ninety-Five Theses, going against many practices of the Roman Catholic Church. The church had to talk about what he believed, causing disagreements within and marking the beginning of the Protestant Reformation.



PROTESTANT REFORMATION – A sixteenth-century movement to reform the Catholic Church dominated by Rome. Martin Luther was one of the main Protestant reformers. Several traditions of anti-Catholic Christianity developed out of the movement

3.3 Print and Dissent

In the 16th century, Menocchio started reading books in his area. He rethought the Bible's message and came up with his own ideas about God and Creation that angered the Roman Catholic Church. Menocchio faced charges twice and was eventually put to death. In 1558, the Roman Church began keeping a list of forbidden books called the Index of Prohibited Books.

INQUISITION – A FORMER ROMAN CATHOLIC COURT FOR IDENTIFYING AND PUNISHING HERETICS

HERETICAL – BELIEFS WHICH DO NOT FOLLOW THE ACCEPTED TEACHINGS OF THE CHURCH. IN MEDIEVAL TIMES, HERESY WAS SEEN AS A THREAT TO THE RIGHT OF THE CHURCH TO DECIDE ON WHAT SHOULD BE BELIEVED AND WHAT SHOULD NOT. HERETICAL BELIEFS WERE SEVERELY PUNISHED

SATIETY – THE STATE OF BEING FULFILLED MUCH BEYOND THE POINT OF SATISFACTION

SEDITIONOUS – ACTION, SPEECH OR WRITING THAT IS SEEN AS OPPOSING THE GOVERNMENT

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4 The Reading Mania

- As literacy and schools spread in European countries, there was a virtual reading mania.
- New forms of popular literature appeared in print, targeting new audiences.
- In England, penny chapbooks were carried by petty pedlars known as chapmen, and sold for a penny, so that even the poor could buy them.
- In France, were the "Biliotheque Bleue", which were low-priced small books printed on poor-quality paper, and bound in cheap blue covers.
- Then there were the romances, printed on four to six pages, and the more substantial 'histories' which were stories about the past.
- Similarly, the ideas of scientists and philosophers now became more accessible to the common people.

4.1 'Tremble, therefore, tyrants of the world!'

- Books were considered as a means of spreading progress and enlightenment by the mid-eighteenth century.
- According to Louise-Sebastien Mercier, a novelist in eighteenth-century France said that 'The printing press is the most powerful engine of progress and public opinion is the force that will sweep despotism away.
- ' Convinced of the power of print in bringing enlightenment and destroying the basis of despotism, Mercier proclaimed: 'Tremble, therefore, tyrants of the world! Tremble before the virtual writer!'

4.2 Print Culture and the French Revolution

Historians argued that print culture created the conditions for the French Revolution. Three types of arguments were put forward.

- Print popularized Enlightenment ideas, with writings by thinkers like Voltaire and Rousseau questioning tradition, superstition, and despotism.
- The public embraced a new perspective through print, characterized by questioning, critical, and rational thinking.
- Printing fostered a culture of dialogue and debate, giving rise to ideas of social revolution.
- In the 1780s, literature mocking royalty and criticizing their morality flourished, reflecting the impact of print on public opinion.

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5 The Nineteenth Century

The nineteenth century saw vast leaps in mass literacy in Europe, bringing in large numbers of new readers among children, women and workers.

5.1 Children, Women and Workers

- In the late 19th century, primary education became mandatory.
- In 1857, a children's press dedicated to children's literature was established in France.
- The Grimm Brothers collected traditional folk tales in Germany, transforming rural stories.
- Women took on significant roles as both readers and writers.
- Magazines and manuals focusing on women's interests, proper behavior, and housekeeping were published.
- In the 19th century, lending libraries in England served as tools for educating white-collar workers, artisans, and those in the lower-middle class.

5.2 Further Innovations

- Press came to be made out of metal by the late eighteenth century.
- Printing technology saw a series of further innovations by the 19th century.
- During that century, power-driven cylindrical press was perfected by Richard M, which was particularly used for printing newspapers.
- The offset was developed which was capable of printing six colours at a time.
- By the 20th century, electrically operated presses accelerated printing operations followed by other series of development.
- Methods of feeding paper improved
- The quality of plates became better
- Automatic paper reels and photoelectric controls of the colour register were introduced

6 India and the World of Print

6.1 Manuscripts Before the Age of Print

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India has a long legacy of producing handwritten manuscripts in many different vernaculars as well as in Sanskrit, Arabic, and Persian. These handwritten writings were printed on either homemade paper or palm-leaf paper. After the invention of print, the manuscript was still being produced. It is regarded as being extremely pricey and delicate. Many pupils in Bengal were literate without ever having read any form of literature since they were solely taught how to write.



Pages from the Diwan of Hafiz, 1824.

Hafiz was a fourteenth-century poet whose collected works are known as Diwan. Notice the beautiful calligraphy and the elaborate illustration and design. Manuscripts like this continued to be produced for the rich even after the coming of the letterpress.

6.2 Print Comes to India

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- In the mid-sixteenth century, Portuguese missionaries introduced the first printing press to Goa.
- Catholic priests printed the initial Tamil book in 1579 in Cochin, and in 1713, they printed the first Malayalam book.
- The English press was established relatively late in India, despite the English East India Company importing presses from the late seventeenth century.
- James Augustus Hickey edited the *Bengal Gazette*, a weekly magazine, where he published advertisements and gossiped about the Company's senior officials in India.
- By the end of the eighteenth century, numerous newspapers and journals were in print.

7 Religious Reform and Public Debates

Printed tracts and newspapers not only spread new ideas, but they shaped the nature of the debate.

During this period, there were heated debates between social and religious reformers and Hindu traditionalists on topics such as widow immolation, monotheism, Brahmanical priesthood, and idolatry. In 1821, Rammohun Roy published the *Sambad Kaumudi*, and in response, the Hindu traditionalists commissioned the *Samachar Chandrika* to counter his views.

In northern India, religious scholars (ulama) were concerned that colonial rulers might promote conversion and alter Muslim personal laws. In response, they utilized affordable lithographic presses to publish Persian and Urdu translations of sacred texts, along with religious newspapers and pamphlets. The Deoband Seminary, established in 1867, issued numerous fatwas guiding Muslim readers on their daily conduct and clarifying the principles of Islamic doctrines.

8 New Forms of Publication

- New kinds of writing were introduced as more and more people got interested in reading.
- In Europe, the novel, a literary form, was developed to cater to the needs of people who acquired Indian forms and styles.
- New literary forms entered the world of reading such as lyrics, short stories, essays about social and political matters.
- New visual culture took shape by the end of the nineteenth century.
- Cheap calendars were available in the bazaar which can be bought even by the poor to decorate the walls of their homes or places of work.
- These prints began shaping popular ideas about modernity and tradition, religion and politics, and society and culture.
- Caricatures and cartoons were being published in journals and newspapers, commenting on social and political issues by 1870s.



RAJA RITUDHWAJ RESCUING PRINCESS MADALSA
FROM THE CAPTIVITY OF DEMONS. PRINT BY RAVI VARMA.
RAJA RAVI VARMA PRODUCED INNUMERABLE MYTHOLOGICAL
PAINTINGS THAT WERE PRINTED AT THE RAVI VARMA PRESS.

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8.1 Women and Print

Women's reading significantly increased in middle-class households, with the establishment of schools for women in urban areas. Journals also began featuring writings by women, advocating for female education. However, some conservative Hindus and Muslims held concerns: Hindus feared that literate girls would become widowed, while Muslims worried about women being corrupted by reading Urdu romances.

Social reforms and novels sparked a keen interest in women's lives and emotions. In the early 20th century, women-written and edited journals gained immense popularity. In Bengal, a specific area in central Calcutta, known as Battala, was dedicated to printing popular books. By the late 19th century, many of these books were richly illustrated with woodcuts and colored lithographs. Peddlers distributed Battala publications to homes, allowing women to read them during their leisure time.

8.2 Print and the Poor People

Small, inexpensive books were offered for sale to the underprivileged in Madras throughout the nineteenth century. Caste discrimination concerns first appear in several printed texts and articles in the late 19th century, including those by Jyotiba Phule, B.R Ambedkar, and E.V Ramaswamy Naicker. Lack of knowledge prevented factory employees from writing extensively about their experiences. In order to demonstrate the connections between caste and class exploitation, Kashi Baba authored and published *Chhote Aur Bade Ka Sawal* in 1938. Bangalore cotton mill workers established libraries in the 1930s so they could educate themselves.

9 Print and Censorship

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- Censorship was not a concern under the East India Company.
- The Calcutta Supreme Court passed certain regulations to control press freedom and in 1835, Governor-General Bentinck agreed to revise press laws.
- Thomas Macaulay formulated new rules that restored the earlier freedom.
- The freedom of press changed after the revolt of 1857.
- In 1878, the Vernacular Press Act was passed, modelled on the Irish Press Laws, which provided the government with extensive rights to censor reports and editorials in the vernacular press.
- Government started keeping track of the vernacular newspapers.
- Nationalists newspapers grew in numbers all over India.
- In 1907, Punjab revolutionaries were deported, Bal Gangadhar Tilak wrote with great sympathy about them in his *Kesari* which led to his imprisonment in 1908.

EXPHUB 9 & 10



TOP 7 QUESTIONS

Q.Explain with examples how print culture catered to the requirement of children.

- (i) Primary education became compulsory from the late nineteenth century; children became an important category of readers. Production of school textbooks became critical for the publishing industry.
- (ii) A children's press devoted to literature for children alone, was set up in France in 1857.
- (iii) This press published new works as well as old fairy tales and folk tales.
- (iv) The Grimm Brothers in Germany spent years compiling traditional folk tales gathered from peasants. What they collected was edited before the stories were published in a collection in 1812.
- (v) Anything that was considered unsuitable for children or would appear vulgar to the elites, was not included in the published version. Rural folk tales thus acquired a new form. In this way, print recorded old tales but also changed them.

Q.'With the printing press a new public emerged in Europe'. Justify the statement.

- (i) The earliest kind of print technology was developed in China, Japan and Korea. In China woodblocks were used for hand printing.
- (ii) Up to the 6th-century print was used only by the scholar-officials but later it became common.
- (iii) The Buddhist Missionaries introduced hand printing technology from China to Japan.
- (iv) It was Marco Polo, a great explorer, who brought printing knowledge of woodblock from China to Italy.
- (v) The invention of the printing press proved great miracle in spreading knowledge.

Q. "The 'Print Revolution' had transformed the lives of people changing their relationship to information and knowledge." Analyse the statement.

- Transformation due to Print Revolution:
 - (i) It influenced people's perception and opened up new ways of looking at things.
 - (ii) A new reading public emerged.
 - (iii) Created the possibility of wide circulation of ideas.
 - (iv) Introduced a new world of debate and discussion.
 - (v) Stimulated many distinctive individual interpretations of faith.

Q. Explain the reasons favouring shift from hand printing to mechanical printing in China.

- The reasons favouring the shift from hand printing to mechanical printing in China are:
- (i) Textbooks of the Civil Service Examination were printed in vast numbers under the sponsorship of the Imperial State. From the sixteenth century, the number of examination candidates went up and that increased the volume of print.
 - (ii) By the seventeenth century, the print was no longer used just by scholar-officials. Merchants used the print in their everyday life, as they collected Trade information.
 - (iii) Reading increasingly became a leisure activity. The new readership preferred fictional narratives, poetry, autobiographies, anthologies of literary masterpieces, and romantic plays.
 - (iv) Rich women began to read, and many women began publishing their poetry and plays. Wives of scholar officials published their works and courtesans wrote about their lives. The new reading culture was accompanied by the new technology. Western printing techniques and mechanical presses were imported into China and Shanghai became the new hub of the new print culture.

Q. "Issues of caste discrimination began to be written about in many printed tracts and essays in India in the late nineteenth century." Support the statements with two suitable examples.

-
- In 1871, 'Gulamgiri', a work written by Jyotiba Phule, the Maratha pioneer of the low caste movement, addressed the inequalities inherent in the caste system.
 - Caste-based discrimination was a prominent theme in the popular and widely read works of E.V. Ramaswamy Naicker and B.R. Ambedkar, which discussed social issues.
 - Many regional protest movements and parties published periodicals and articles criticizing religious texts and envisioning a new societal outlook.
 - In 1938, Kashibaba, a millworker from Kanpur, authored 'Chhote Aur Bade Ka Sawal' to illustrate the connection between class and caste mistreatment.
 - The cotton mill workers of Bangalore began establishing libraries in 1930 to educate themselves, following the example set by the Bombay mill workers.
 - As a result of these efforts, people from lower castes became increasingly aware of the need to criticize ancient scriptures and develop a society that was free of caste discrimination, based on equality.

Q. How had novels been easily available to the masses in Europe during the nineteenth century? Explain with examples

- The emergence of a new reading public was attributed to the printing press invention which reduced the cost of book production. With decreased time and labor, multiple copies could be produced with ease, resulting in books flooding the market and becoming easily accessible to the masses. This led to the publication of popular ballads and folk tales, which were profusely illustrated with pictures and widely read by the masses.

Q.What is manuscript? Mention any two limitations of it, during the nineteenth century.

- ① Manuscripts were documents or books written by hand. They were not used widely because:
- (a) They could not satisfy the ever-increasing demand for books.
 - (b) They were expensive as copying was an expensive, laborious and time-consuming business.
 - (c) Manuscripts were fragile, awkward to handle and could not be carried around or read easily.
 - (d) Their circulation was limited

IMPORTANT IMPORTANT DATES

594 ad: From 594 ad books in China were printed by wrapping paper
 768 to 778ad : Hand printing Technology introduced in Japan
 868 ad : The first and oldest Japanese book printed
 1295 : Marco Polo returned to Italy
 1448 : By 1448 Gutenberg perfected the printing press system
 1450 and 1550 : Between 1450 and 1550 printing press spread all over Europe
 1517 : Religious Reform mark Martin Luther Wrote 95 theses criticizing many of the practices and rituals of the Roman catholic churches
 1579 : First Tamil book was written in Kochin
 1710 : Dutch protestant Missionaries had printed 32 Tamil texts
 1713 : The first Malayalam book was printed
 1810 : The Ramcharitmanas of Tulsidas came out from Calcutta
 1821 : SambadKaumudi begin to published Ram Mohan Roy
 1822 : From 1822 Jaam is Jahan numa and shamshul Akbar was started
 1867 : Deoband seminary was founded
 1871 : Gulamgiri was published
 1878 : The Vernacular Press Act
 1907 : Punjab revolutionaries were deported
 1930s : Great Depression